

9 Normative Ethics Background Quiz

1. What is moral relativism, as defined in the deck?

- A) There is no objective standard of morality that applies to all people in all situations
- B) Morality can be derived only from the written laws that a particular society has
- C) Moral questions have no answers at all, because they are purely empirical matters
- D) One single moral code applies to everyone in every culture at every point in time

ANS:

2. Which of the following is an intrinsic good rather than an instrumental good?

- A) Love
- B) Money
- C) Career opportunities
- D) Power

ANS:

3. How does the deck define wellbeing as pleasure (hedonism)?

- A) Wellbeing is determined by a person's income and wealth
- B) Wellbeing is a set of objective goods such as knowledge
- C) Wellbeing is the satisfaction of whatever we desire
- D) The balance of pleasure over pain constitutes wellbeing

ANS:

4. Why does the deck say that revealed preferences can be more useful than stated preferences?

- A) People always say exactly what they prefer, so stated preferences are fully reliable
- B) Revealed preferences can never conflict with the stated preferences people report
- C) Stated preferences always change faster over time than revealed preferences do
- D) A revealed preference illustrates our actions, not our intentions

ANS:

5. What is an informed preference?

- A) It is whatever someone happens to say that they prefer in casual conversation
- B) It is whatever someone happened to choose at some time in the distant past
- C) It considers all relevant information and can change as more is learned
- D) It is a preference that can never change over time, however much is learned

ANS:

6. What is meant by objective goods in the account of wellbeing?

- A) Things that are good because they maximize profit for the people who own them
- B) Things that are good independent of personal beliefs or opinions
- C) Things that are good only if a person happens to desire them at the time
- D) Things that are good because they give a particular person a great deal of pleasure

ANS:

7. What risk does the deck mention about AI chatbot companions that aim to maximize revealed preferences?

- A) They may addict us and leave us unhappy
- B) They may refuse to talk
- C) They may give us shallow but amusing content
- D) They may push us toward self-development goals we may not wish

ANS:

8. What is the difference between constraints and obligations?

- A) Constraints require certain actions, while obligations prohibit certain actions
- B) Both are legal rules that have no moral significance
- C) Constraints prohibit certain actions, while obligations require certain actions
- D) Both are actions that are morally optional to perform

ANS:

9. What is the difference between positive and negative rights?

- A) Positive rights require others to abstain, while negative rights require others to act
- B) Both positive and negative rights require only abstention from others
- C) Positive rights require others to act, while negative rights require others to abstain
- D) Positive rights apply only to humans, while negative rights apply only to animals

ANS:

10. What do impartial moral theories imply?

- A) We should value our friends and family more than strangers
- B) We should value individual lives equally
- C) We should ignore all rules
- D) We should value only our own life

ANS:

11. Why do some philosophers, such as hedonists, argue that non-human animals should be included in the moral circle?

- A) Their ability to speak a human language
- B) Their ability to vote in elections
- C) Their capacity for suffering
- D) Their ability to sign legal contracts

ANS:

12. How does the deck describe normative ethics?

- A) The study of the underlying concepts that make moral reasoning possible in the first place
- B) A description of how people actually behave in real situations that involve morality
- C) A set of empirical findings about which preferences people hold in practice
- D) Concrete moral standards and principles that govern how we ought to behave

ANS:

13. According to utilitarianism, which action is right?

- A) The one that increases overall wellbeing the most, impartially and globally
- B) The one that best respects long-standing tradition and the customs of the community
- C) The one that follows a fixed rule, regardless of what its consequences turn out to be
- D) The one that benefits only the agent's own family and close friends the most

ANS:

14. In the Drunk Driving example (probabilities 0.95 for getting home safely with utility +1 and 0.05 for a fatal accident with utility -1000), what is the expected utility of driving home?

- A) +0.95
- B) -49.05
- C) -49.5
- D) -1000

ANS:

15. What is the point of Nozick's Experience Machine as a critique of utilitarianism?

- A) It shows that people's preferences are always stable and consistent over long periods of time
- B) It proves that pleasure is the only thing that has any value for human beings
- C) It suggests utilitarianism over-emphasizes wellbeing, since most people would refuse to plug in
- D) It shows that everyone would gladly choose to plug in to the machine for life

ANS:

16. What is the demandingness objection to utilitarianism?

- A) Utilitarianism demands that people never calculate anything about the outcomes of their acts
- B) Utilitarianism prohibits all giving to charity by individuals, however wealthy they are
- C) Utilitarianism requires people to do only what is legal in the place where they live
- D) If our money helps others more than it helps us, utilitarianism offers no reason to keep it

ANS:

17. How does the utilitarian respond to the objection that it requires intractable reasoning?

- A) Calculation is always possible and perfectly precise in practice
- B) A theory's criterion of rightness need not match its decision procedure
- C) The theory cannot guide action at all, and utilitarians concede this
- D) There is no criterion of rightness for utilitarianism at all

ANS:

18. Which of the following is a key idea of deontology?

- A) Always maximize total wellbeing across every one of the people who are affected
- B) Focus on constraints and obligations rather than the best outcome, protecting human autonomy
- C) Judge every single action only by the quality of its consequences for everyone
- D) Treat all moral rules as entirely optional whenever they become inconvenient to follow

ANS:

19. According to the Doctrine of Double Effect, when is an agent morally allowed to carry out an action that predictably leads to a bad outcome?

- A) Never, regardless of what the agent's intentions happen to be at the time
- B) When the agent intends the bad effect as a means of bringing about the good one
- C) Whenever the bad effect happens to be relatively small compared to the good effect
- D) When the agent intends the good effect but not the bad effect

ANS:

20. What difficulty does the deck raise for threshold deontology (deferring to consequences when enough lives are at stake)?

- A) There is no clear, non-arbitrary way to say how many lives are "enough"
- B) It never defers to consequences, however many lives happen to be at stake
- C) It always gives exactly the same verdicts as utilitarianism in every possible case
- D) It rejects every constraint, including those on keeping promises and on honesty

ANS: